

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

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Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen teams up with Meal Ticket to digitise foodservice B2B payments

Foodservice distributors spend a lot of time chasing checks and reconciling invoices. Meal Ticket wants to fix that, and it's plugging Adyen's payments stack straight into its platform to do it. The tie-up means distributors can accept cards and bank transfers, settle faster, and auto-reconcile inside the tools they already use—rather than juggling portals and paper. For Adyen, it's another ISV-led move into B2B, a segment ripe for embedded payments and richer data that can unlock lower interchange via Level II/III processing. For Meal Ticket, payments add a new revenue stream and make its software stickier. The real win: better cash flow and fewer manual headaches for distributors whose customers span restaurants, convenience stores, and institutions. The catch: card fees can bite, so adoption will hinge on offering ACH and pricing that makes sense for high-ticket invoices. Big picture, this is part of a broader land grab where SaaS platforms bake payments into workflows. Expect more distributors to swap "check in the mail" for click-to-pay—and more payment processors to court niche B2B verticals with embedded solutions.

Source: PaymentsDive

<https://www.paymentsdive.com/press-release/20240826-meal-ticket-partners-with-adyen-to-launch-payment-solutions-for-food-service-1/>

Article 2

Adyen plugs into Plaid to power pay by bank at checkout

Adyen has teamed up with Plaid to make bank to bank payments and account verification a first class option at checkout. Think of it as a lower cost alternative to cards: Plaid's Link flow handles bank login and account checks (Auth and Balance), while Adyen wraps it with acquiring, risk controls, and settlement for enterprise merchants. The pitch is straightforward—fewer card fees, fewer chargebacks, and fewer failed ACH debits thanks to real time balance checks. For merchants, this adds another lever in the payment mix: steer repeat customers, subscriptions, bill pay, or high ticket transactions to pay by bank, and keep cards for impulse buys and loyalty driven shoppers. The catch? Consumer habits are sticky, card rewards are compelling, and ACH in the U.S. still isn't truly instant or dispute friendly. But with Plaid's reach across thousands of financial institutions and Adyen's global merchant base, expect more experiments with checkout design and incentives (think discounts for bank payments) as margins tighten. Strategically, it puts Adyen toe to toe with rivals pushing account to account rails—another nudge toward a future where cards don't dominate every transaction.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/>

Article 3

Adyen rolls out embedded finance in the US: Capital, Accounts, and Issuing

Adyen just took a big step beyond payments in the US. The Dutch fintech unveiled a suite of embedded finance tools—Adyen Capital (data-driven cash advances), Accounts (business accounts with instant access to funds), and Issuing (virtual and physical cards)—so platforms, marketplaces, and SaaS/POS providers can offer bank-like services right inside their software. The pitch is simple: use first party payments data to underwrite faster, keep money flows on-platform, and unlock new revenue from interchange and fees. What it means: Adyen is nudging from processor to operating system for commerce, boosting take rates and customer stickiness while giving merchants quicker access to cash and smoother payouts. It also turns platform clients into mini-financial hubs, a handy moat in a crowded software market. The flipside? More exposure to credit cycles and compliance heavy-lifting—areas that traditional banks and BaaS specialists won't cede quietly. But if Adyen manages risk well, this could be a meaningful ARPU uplift and a deeper moat, as merchants increasingly expect capital, accounts, and cards to come bundled with payments.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/>

Article 4

Adyen taps BNPL boom with deeper Klarna tie-up ahead of holidays

Buy now, pay later is set to surge again this holiday season, and Adyen wants in on the checkout action. The Dutch payments processor is expanding its integration with Swedish BNPL giant Klarna, making it easier for merchants to switch on instalment options across online and in-store channels via a single Adyen setup. That matters because BNPL tends to lift conversion rates and basket sizes when budgets are tight, yet many retailers still grapple with complex integrations and fragmented providers. Adyen's pitch is simple: one platform, more payment choice, less friction. For Adyen, it's a volume play—more transactions flowing through its rails without taking on credit risk (that sits with Klarna). For merchants, it's a timely lever to capture demand without rolling out new contracts or hardware. And for Klarna, it's wider distribution at the point of decision. The catch? BNPL isn't free—fees can be higher than cards, returns are messy, and regulatory scrutiny is rising. Still, with peak season underway, removing hurdles at checkout could be the difference between abandoned carts and closed sales.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/>

Article 5

Square's 'Handheld' cuts the phone out of POS — and tightens the ecosystem

Square made its name turning smartphones into card terminals. Now it's ditching the phone. Its new device, Handheld, is an all in one mobile POS that bakes payments and software into a single unit, aiming squarely at line busting retail and tableside restaurants that want fewer moving parts. The pitch is simple: better reliability, simpler staff training, tighter control over battery life and connectivity, and no worries about employees' personal phones or OS updates breaking the setup. For Square, this isn't just a gadget play. It's a strategic nudge toward higher hardware attachment, stickier subscriptions, and enterprise style device management — the kind of bundle that reduces churn and deepens wallet share. It also answers rivals like Toast and Clover, which have used dedicated handhelds to win multi location accounts. The trade offs? More capital tied up in hardware, the risk of cannibalizing "Tap to Pay" on phones, and the need to prove total cost of ownership beats BYOD. But if Handheld drives more consistent uptime and faster checkout, the processing volume it protects could more than pay for itself — and pull merchants deeper into Square's stack.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/>

Article 6

Square adds bitcoin at checkout for small businesses

Tap to pay just met HODL. Square is expanding its toolkit with bitcoin payment capabilities, as small businesses feel pressure to keep up with emerging tech. In practice, it means shoppers can choose to pay with BTC, while Square handles the rails. For merchants, the upside is access to crypto native customers, a bit of marketing buzz, and potentially smoother cross border transactions. The catch? Bitcoin's price swings, tax and accounting complexity, and uncertain everyday demand. If Square lets sellers instantly convert BTC to dollars, it could blunt volatility risk—though fees and compliance will still matter. Strategically, this is Block leaning into its crypto thesis, weaving Bitcoin into its merchant stack to keep sellers loyal and to counter rivals like PayPal and Shopify. For payment execs, the metrics to watch are uptake among high ticket or online first merchants, how many opt for instant conversion versus settlement in BTC, and whether cross border flows show real savings. If adoption sticks, bitcoin may graduate from asset to niche payment method. If not, it's still a handy differentiator that helps Square win merchants today, even if it doesn't move transaction volumes immediately.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

Square rings up its first Bitcoin latte at Compass Coffee

A Compass Coffee in Washington, D.C. just became the first store to accept a bitcoin payment through Square's new point-of-sale system. It's a small cup of coffee, but a big signal: Block (Square's parent) wants to move bitcoin from speculative asset to everyday tender at the till. For merchants, the promise is convenience—turn on a new tender type in the same POS, and let Square handle the heavy lifting. The real questions for payment folks are practical: What do fees look like versus card interchange? How are volatility, refunds, and tax reporting handled? And is checkout fast enough to matter at a busy café? Crypto payments are push-based and irreversible, which could mean fewer chargebacks but new refund workflows. If Square can make settlement simple and pricing compelling, thousands of SMBs could flip the feature on without touching crypto custody. If not, this stays a PR-friendly pilot. The takeaway: watch how Square packages this—UX, pricing, and settlement will determine whether card rails feel any pressure or whether this remains another novelty brew.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/squares-platform-sees-first-bitcoin-payment-at-coffee-shop/>

